

Verification of Functional Programs

Andrés Sicard-Ramírez

Universidad EAFIT

Semester 2026-1

Outline

- Pacto Pedagógico
- Introduction
- Induction
- Isabelle/HOL
- References

Pacto Pedagógico

Como miembros de la Universidad EAFIT, nos comprometemos a actuar de manera íntegra siguiendo los más altos estándares éticos y morales.

- Respeto
- Tolerancia
- Honradez
- Compromiso

Pacto Pedagógico

Página web del curso

<https://asr.github.io/courses/verification-of-functional-programs/2026-1>

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Conducto regular, fechas y porcentajes de las evaluaciones

La información está en la página web del curso.

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Responsabilidad compartida

- Profesor
- Estudiantes

Pacto Pedagógico

Asistencia a clase

Reglamento académico de los programas de posgrado, Capítulo VI, Artículo 62, Parágrafo 2.

“El estudiante de posgrado cuyas faltas de asistencia lleguen al treinta por ciento (30%) del total de las horas de clase programadas para el curso o para una parte de éste, cuando se desarrolle con más de un profesor, en secciones temáticas denominadas ‘módulo’, pierde con calificación de cero punto cero (0.0) del seminario o curso correspondiente y esta nota afecta el promedio crédito acumulado.”

Pacto Pedagógico

Orientaciones para el curso

- Se recomienda cuatro horas de trabajo por semana (dos horas por cada hora de clase).
- Las clases son presenciales.
- La evaluación a la docencia es obligatoria.
- Se recomienda revisar periódicamente los canales de comunicación institucionales (EAFIT Interactiva y el correo institucional).
- El estudiante podrá entrar a clase a más tardar 20 minutos después de la hora asignada para su inicio.

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Interactive Proof Assistants

Description

*“Proof assistants are computer systems that allow a user to do mathematics on a computer, but not so much the computing (numerical or symbolical) aspect of mathematics but the aspects of **proving** and **defining**. So a user can **set up** a mathematical theory, define properties and do logical reasoning with them.”*
(Geuvers 2009, p. 3.)

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Examples

- Based on set theory: Isabelle/ZFC, Metamath and Mizar
- Based on higher-order logic: HOL4, HOL Light and Isabelle/HOL
- Based on type theories: Agda, Rocq and Lean.

Isabelle

- University of Cambridge (England) and Technical University of Munich (German)
- Based on higher-order logic
- Tactic-based
- Extraction of programs to Haskell, OCaml, Scala and SML
- Written in SML
- Integration with ATPs and SMT solvers

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Sets Defined by Induction

Example

We inductively define the set of natural numbers Nat .

Usual definition.

- (i) $\text{zero} : \text{Nat}$.
- (ii) If $n \in \text{Nat}$ then $\text{succ } n : \text{Nat}$.

Definition using inference rules.

$$\frac{}{\text{zero} : \text{Nat}} \qquad \frac{n : \text{Nat}}{\text{succ } n : \text{Nat}}$$

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$$\frac{}{\text{zero} : \text{Nat}} \qquad \frac{n : \text{Nat}}{\text{succ } n : \text{Nat}}$$

Remark: In both definitions the fact that Nat is the smallest set generated by the clauses/rules is not stated explicitly.

Structural Induction

Example

Let P be a unary property on $\mathbf{Nat}$. To prove that $P\ n$ for all $n : \mathbf{Nat}$, we can use **structural induction** for P .

$$\frac{\begin{array}{c} [P\ n] \\ \vdots \\ P\ \text{zero} \quad P\ (\text{succ } n) \end{array}}{P\ n} \text{ (structural induction)}$$

Structural Induction

Example

Let A be a set. We inductively define the lists of elements of A , denoted $\text{List } A$, by the following inference rules:

$$\frac{}{\text{nil} : \text{List } A} \qquad \frac{x : A \quad xs : \text{List } A}{\text{cons } x \ xs : \text{List } A}$$

Structural Induction

Example

Let A be a set. We inductively define the lists of elements of A , denoted $\text{List } A$, by the following inference rules:

$$\frac{}{\text{nil} : \text{List } A} \qquad \frac{x : A \quad xs : \text{List } A}{\text{cons } x \ xs : \text{List } A}$$

Let A be a set and let P be a unary property on $\text{List } A$. To prove that $P \ xs$ for all $xs : \text{List } A$, we can use **structural induction** for P and $\text{List } A$.

$$\frac{\begin{array}{c} [P \ xs] \\ \vdots \\ P \ \text{nil} \quad P \ (\text{cons } x \ xs) \end{array}}{P \ xs} \text{ (structural induction)}$$

Computation Induction

Example

We recursively define the division by 2 (rounded downwards) function.

$$\lfloor \text{div2} \rfloor : \text{Nat} \rightarrow \text{Nat}$$

$$\lfloor \text{div2} \rfloor \text{ zero} = \text{zero}$$

$$\lfloor \text{div2} \rfloor (\text{succ zero}) = \text{zero}$$

$$\lfloor \text{div2} \rfloor (\text{succ (succ } n)) = \text{succ } (\lfloor \text{div2} \rfloor n)$$

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Let P be a unary property on Nat and $\lfloor \text{div2} \rfloor$. To prove that $P\ n$ for all $n : \text{Nat}$, we can use **computation induction** for P and $\lfloor \text{div2} \rfloor$.

$$\frac{\begin{array}{c} [P\ n] \\ \vdots \\ P\ \text{zero} \quad P\ (\text{succ zero}) \quad P\ (\text{succ (succ } n)) \end{array}}{P\ n} \text{ (computation induction)}$$

Rule Induction

Example

We inductively define the inductive relation **Even** on natural numbers by the following rules:

$$\frac{}{\text{zero} : \text{Even}} \qquad \frac{n : \text{Even}}{\text{succ} (\text{succ } n) : \text{Even}}$$

Rule Induction

Example

We inductively define the inductive relation **Even** on natural numbers by the following rules:

$$\frac{}{\text{zero} : \text{Even}} \qquad \frac{n : \text{Even}}{\text{succ} (\text{succ } n) : \text{Even}}$$

Let P be a unary property on **Nat**. To prove that $\text{Even } n \Rightarrow P \ n$, we can use **rule induction** for P and **Even**.

$$\frac{\begin{array}{c} [\text{Even } n, P \ n] \\ \vdots \\ \text{Even } n \quad P \ \text{zero} \quad P \ (\text{succ} (\text{succ } n)) \end{array}}{P \ n} \text{ (rule induction)}$$

Rule Inversion

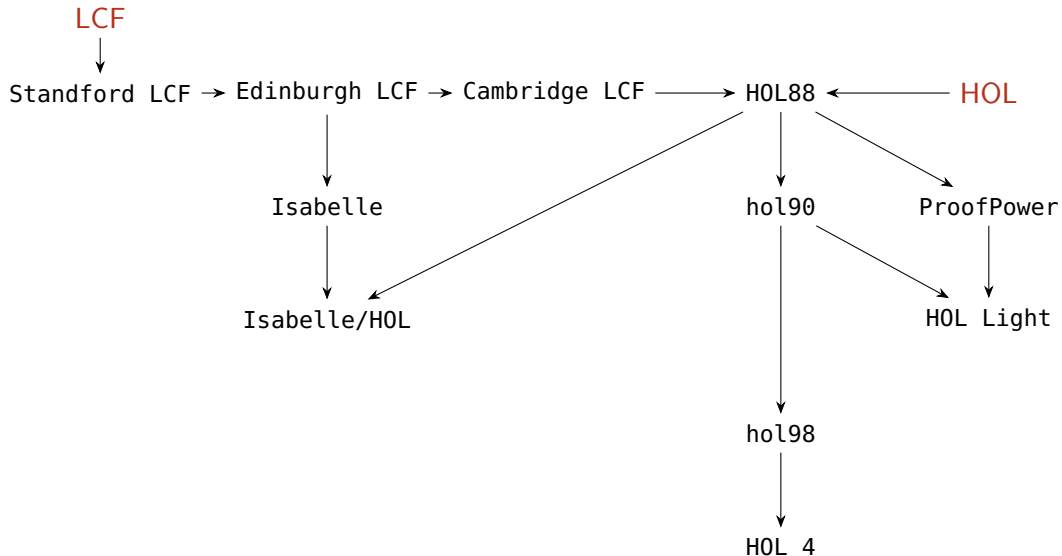
Example

Rule inversion goes in the opposite direction to rule induction. For example, given **Even** n we can use rule inversion for asking which rules could have been used to derive **Even** n and what constraints these rules impose on n .

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LCF and HOL Proof Checkers and Proof Assistants



Generalisation of first, second, third, ...-order logics

*"It seems very natural to extend the system F of first-order logic by permitting quantification on predicate, propositional, and function variables as well as individual variables. One thus obtains the wffs of a system of **second-order logic**. One might then introduce predicate and function variables of higher type to denote relations and functions whose arguments may be relations and functions of individuals as well as individuals. Thus one would be led to a system of **third-order logic**, and if one permitted quantification with respect to these new variables, one would obtain a system of **fourth-order logic**. This process can be continued indefinitely to obtain logics of arbitrarily high order. Of course, after a while one runs out of different types of letters to use for different types of variables, but this problem can be solved by introducing **type symbols** to indicate the types of variables, and using a letter with type symbol α as subscript for a variable of type α ."* (Andrews [1986] 2002, p. 201)

HOL (Higher-Order Logic)

Paper: Alonzo Church (1940). “A Formulation of the Simple Theory of Types”.

Also called “simple type theory” or “Church’s type theory”.

Types: Base types (ι of individuals and o of truth values), variables have fixed types, function types.

Terms: Variables, constants, λ -abstractions and function application.

First-order logic with equality: Formulae are of type o .

Sets: Sets of individuals with type $\iota \rightarrow o$, sets of sets of individuals with type $(\iota \rightarrow o) \rightarrow o$, etc.

“Church’s type theory has been extensively studied by two of Church’s students, L. Henkin and P. Andrews. . . Henkin also showed in [30] that Church’s type theory could be reformulated using only four primitive notions: function application, function abstraction, equality, and definite description. . . Andrews formulated a version of Church’s type theory called Q_0 that employs the ideas developed by Church, Henkin, and himself.” (Farmer 2008, p. 269)



LCF (Logic for Computable Functions)

Paper: Dana S. Scott ([1969] 1993). “A Type-Theoretical Alternative to ISWIM, CUCH, OWHY”.

Typed combinatory logic for reasoning about computable (continuous) functions including partial and non-terminating ones.

Types: Interpreted via domain theory.

Recursive functions: Interpreted via least-fixed points.



Stanford LCF

Paper: Robin Milner (1972). “Logic for Computable Functions. Description of a Machine Implementation”.

Proof checker for LCF.



Edinburgh LCF

Book: Michael J. Gordon, Robin Milner and Christopher P. Wadsworth (1979). “Edinburgh LCF. A Mechanised Logic of Computation”.

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A solution:

“He [Milner] had the idea that instead of saving whole proofs, the system should just remember the results of proofs, namely theorems. . . To ensure that theorems could only be created by proof, Milner had the brilliant idea of using an abstract data type whose predefined values were instances of axioms and whose operations were inference rules. Strict typechecking then ensured that the only values that could be created were those that could be obtained from axioms by applying a sequence of inference rules—namely theorems.” (M. J. C. Gordon 2000, p. 170)

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Introduction: The functional programming language ML (Meta Language) and the concepts of “tactics” and “tacticals”.

Book: Lawrence C. Paulson ([1987] 2003). “Logic and Computation. Interactive Proof with Cambridge LCF”.

Cambridge LCF

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Many theoretical and technical improvements in relation to Cambridge LCF.

HOL

Paper: Mike Gordon (1985). “HOL. A Machine Oriented Formulation of Higher Order Logic”.

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“In this paper we describe a formal language intended as a basis for hardware specification and verification. This language is not new; the only originality in what follows lies in the presentation of details.” (M. J. C. Gordon 1985, p. 2)

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Logic: Church's HOL with polymorphism and the Axiom of Choice is built-in via Hilbert's ϵ -operator.

(continued on next slide)

Primitive definitional principles

“The HOL system, unlike LCF, emphasises definition rather than axiom postulation as the primary method of developing theories. Higher order logic makes possible a purely definitional development of many mathematical objects (numbers, lists, trees, etc.) and this is supported and encouraged.” (M. J. C. Gordon 2000, p. 174)

(continued on next slide)

HOL

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- Slind (1996) implemented a derived definitional principle for handling general recursive definitions of functions.

Isabelle

Paper: Lawrence C. Paulson (1986). “Natural Deduction as Higher-Order Resolution”.

Paper: Lawrence C. Paulson (1989). “The Foundation of a Generic Theorem Prover”.

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Meta-logic (logic framework): Intuitionistic higher-order logic.

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Meta-logic (logic framework): Intuitionistic higher-order logic.

Isabelle	{	Isabelle/CTT	(extensional constructive type theory)
		Isabelle/FOL	(first-order logic)
		Isabelle/ZF	(Zermelo-Fraenkel set theory)
		Isabelle/HOL	(higher-order logic)

Isabelle/HOL

Book: Tobias Nipkow, Lawrence C. Paulson and Markus Wenzel (2002). “Isabelle/HOL. A Proof Assistant for Higher-Order Logic”.

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- Peter B. Andrews [1986] (2002). An Introduction to Mathematical Logic and Type Theory: To Truth Through Proof. 2nd ed. Vol. 27. Applied Logic Series. Kluwer (cit. on p. 26).
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